Challenge Updates

Updated October 14th, 2026

(*FIRST*® LEGO® League-issued updates supersede all other sources)

(October 14th, 2026)

UPDATE 03 – TREE STABILIZATION (MISSIONS 8 & 9) - Events are encouraged to stabilize the tree model by applying a thin strip of black tape (matte black gaffers tape is recommended) along the mat border, directly behind the tree. Teams should practice and prepare to compete with either a taped or untaped tree, as event conditions may differ from the guidance provided.

UPDATE 02 – RELEASING INTERCHANGEABLE MODELS FROM DOCKS (Missions 13-15) - Programming the robot to remove an interchangeable model from its dock using the model's built-in latch is allowed when done autonomously during the match. This is consistent with Rule 18, which prohibits separation of Dual Lock, taking models apart, or breaking a mission model.

(September 2nd, 2026)

UPDATE 01 - LUCKY LEAVES – Before the match begins, the leaves will be randomized within the nest, and teams will not be told the starting placement of the katydid. This is an intentional part of the challenge. To account for this unpredictability, mission constraints have been updated to extend flexibility. The following mission constraint language replaces the previous version (blue text):

- *The nest is the mission model that holds the leaves and the katydid.*
- *The leaf habitat includes the nest and the marked area on the mat that surrounds it.*
- *If the katydid is completely outside the leaf habitat at any time during the match, the bonus is no longer available.*
- *If the katydid is completely outside the leaf habitat at the end of the match, the team scores zero points for this mission.*

Scoring materials, including the Scoresheets, Robot Game Excel Scorer, and the Event Hub Official Score Calculator, will be updated to reflect this change. Teams and volunteers should download and use the latest version when preparing for events.
